

04 · JOINT CONDITION

Shoulder Pain Recovery Protocol

A four-phase rehab framework for mild shoulder conditions — from acute pain relief through full functional return.

AUTHORED BY

Dorđe Ignjatović

Sport Rehabilitation Specialist

RECOVERY WINDOW

6 – 12 weeks (typical)

THE FOUR-PHASE PROTOCOL

1

PHASE ONE

Acute Management

0 – 72 HOURS

- Cease all activities that provoke pain
- Cryotherapy (cold application) to reduce inflammation
- Short-term immobilization if needed
- Topical cooling cream and anti-swelling / anti-hematoma cream

2

PHASE TWO

Active & Passive Motion

MOBILIZATION PHASE

- Pendular (swinging) exercises
- Light scapular activation
- Restore range of motion progressively
- Cryotherapy, compression, and creams as needed

3

PHASE THREE

Strength & Control

STABILIZATION PHASE

- Resistance exercises with controlled load
- Resistance-band work for rotator-cuff stability
- Achieve full pain-free range of motion
- Cryotherapy, compression, and creams as needed

4

PHASE FOUR

Return to Activity

FUNCTIONAL PHASE

- Gradual return to sport and daily activities
- Speed, endurance, and coordination training



RED FLAGS — WHEN TO STOP & SEEK SPECIALIST CARE

The shoulder is a complex joint — both to diagnose and to rehabilitate — so take these recommendations seriously. Stop training if pain worsens, swelling persists, there is no improvement after 5–7 days, or you feel instability in the joint.

Need a tailored program?

Get in touch for a personalized recovery and rehabilitation plan.

info@sportcaremed.com